

■ TN TRAVELS

Customer Journey & Tern Workflows Guide

A comprehensive reference for advisors

Created: September 25, 2026

Overview

This document provides a complete roadmap of the customer journey from initial inquiry through post-trip follow-up. It outlines the generic customer journey phases and how they integrate with Tern workflows for automation and management. Use this guide to understand timelines, responsibilities, and best practices for advisor operations.

Discovery to Booking	Approximately 4-8 weeks
Booking to Travel	Typically 1-5 months
Key Platforms	Calendly, Travefy, Tern, Outlook
Primary Tool	Tern for workflow automation

The 7 Phases of Customer Journey

Phase 1: Discovery

New Client Inquiry	Platforms: Outlook, Calendly
Discovery Call Email	Within 30 minutes of inquiry
Discovery Call	Within 1-2 weeks
Service Fee Invoice	Within 48 hours of call
Add to CRM & Itinerary	Within 24 hours of confirmation
Supplier Outreach	24-48 hours after discovery call

Phase 2: Proposal

Quote Received	1-2 weeks from suppliers
Create Proposal	3-5 days after quote (usually 1-2)
Send Proposal	Via Travefy
Travel Insurance Quote	Optional discussion item
Proposal Revisions	As needed per client feedback
Proposal Approved	Client approval via Travefy or email

Phase 3: Booking

Initial Bookings	1-3 days after proposal approval
Formal Itinerary	1-5 days after bookings
Second Round Bookings	1-5 months after initial bookings
Registration Tasks	Rewards programs, visas, travel essentials

Phase 4: Destination

Destination Email #1	7-5 months before trip
Destination Email #2	4-3 months before trip
Packing List & Tips	Sent with affiliate links

Phase 5: Pre-Trip

Confirm with Suppliers	105 days before trip
Send Itinerary & Form	90 days before trip
Final Paperwork	20 days before trip
Final Itinerary	14 days before trip
Check-In & Bon Voyage	24-48 hours before trip

Phase 6: Traveling

Arrival Check-In	2 days after trip starts (optional)
On-Trip Support	Available as needed
Rebooking Encouragement	For repeat destinations

Phase 7: Post-Trip

Welcome Home Email	5-7 days after trip ends
Feedback Survey	With review links & referral program
Future Trip Follow-Up #1	30-45 days after trip
Future Trip Follow-Up #2	80-90 days after trip
6-Month Check-In	180 days after trip

Tern Workflow System

Overview

Tern workflows automate and structure the customer journey with predefined tasks, automations, and communication templates. Four main workflow systems guide the complete trip lifecycle: Lead, Planning, Payments, and Pre/Post Travel.

Workflow 1: Starter Lead Workflow

Triggered when a trip is created in Tern or manually applied. Ensures systematic follow-ups with prospective clients.

- 00. Lead | Initial Contact Email - Send inquiry form
- 01. Lead | Initial Contact Follow-Up - Resend inquiry form
- 02. Lead | Schedule Intake Call - Send Calendly link
- 03. Lead | Schedule Intake Call Follow-Up - Reminder email
- 04. Lead | Call Recap, Send Planning Invoice - Post-call summary
- 05. Lead | Upon Payment - Update status to Planning (AUTO)

Key Automations:

- Tern Access - 2 days after trip status change
- Planning Fee Payment Confirmation - Immediately upon status change

Workflow 2: Starter Planning Workflow

Triggered when trip status changes to PLANNING. Manages proposal creation, revisions, and client approval.

- 00. Planning | Contact DMC / Preferred Suppliers - Due 4 days after creation
- 01. Planning | Create & Send Client Proposal - Due 7 days (AUTO)
- 02. Planning | Proposal Follow-Up #1 & #2 - Due 20 days
- 03. Planning | Proposal Updates - Due 14 days if necessary
- 04. Planning | Confirm Bookings with Suppliers - Due 7 days (AUTO)
- 05. Planning | Upon Approval, Update to Booked - Add trip tags (AUTO)

Key Automations:

- Proposal Approved - Upon client approval
- Travel Insurance - 2 days after status change to Planning

Workflow 3: Starter Payments Workflow

Automates payment reminders and confirmations at critical points.

Key Automations:

- Payment Due Reminder 10 Days - Creates follow-up task 5 days after
- Payment Due Reminder 1 Day - Creates follow-up task
- Payment Past Due - Follow-up with client & supplier

Workflow 4: Starter Pre/Post Travel Workflow

Triggered when trip status changes to BOOKED. Manages all pre-trip preparation and post-trip follow-up.

- 00. Request Final Paperwork - 35 days before trip start
- 01. Pre-Travel Documents & Wrap-Up - 22 days before trip start (AUTO)
- 02. Send Hotel Booking Confirmations - 7 days before trip start
- 03. Submit Commission Notes - 5 days before trip start
- 04. Review Trip Feedback - 10 days after trip end (AUTO)

- 05. Archive Trip - 181 days after trip end

Key Automations:

- 90-Day Check-In
- 45-Day Check-In & Profile Refresh
- 24-Hour Flight Check-In Reminder
- Arrival Day Check-In
- Welcome Home Survey

Quick Reference Guide

Key Timelines

Milestone	Timeframe
Discovery Call Email	Within 30 minutes
Discovery Call Scheduled	Within 1-2 weeks
Proposal Created	3-5 days after quote
Booking Initiated	1-3 days after approval
Final Itinerary Sent	14 days before trip
Bon Voyage Email	24-48 hours before trip
Welcome Home Email	5-7 days after trip ends

Advisor Responsibilities by Phase

Phase	Primary Roles	Key Responsibilities
Discovery	Advisor, VA	Intake, CRM setup, supplier research
Proposal	Advisor, VA	Quote management, proposal creation & follow-up
Booking	Advisor, Supplier, VA	CC authorization, booking, itinerary creation
Pre-Trip	Advisor, VA	Final paperwork, confirmations, check-ins
Post-Trip	Advisor, VA	Feedback, follow-up, referral program

Platform Overview

Calendly: Initial inquiry scheduling and discovery call confirmations with automated reminders

Travefy: Proposal creation, management, and final itinerary delivery

Tern: Complete workflow automation, task management, and client communication

Outlook: Direct client inquiries and email communication

Google Docs: Personalized tour recommendations and trip planning (during booking phase)

Tips for Success

- ✓ Set up Tern workflows immediately when trips are created to ensure no client falls through the cracks
- ✓ Use automation extensively—it reduces manual follow-up burden and improves consistency
- ✓ Always confirm timelines with clients during the discovery call to manage expectations
- ✓ Leverage affiliate links in destination emails and tour recommendations for additional revenue

- ✓ Track proposal follow-ups carefully—lack of timely follow-up is identified as a business risk
- ✓ Keep detailed notes during discovery calls and sync to your CRM/Tern within 24 hours
- ✓ Personalize recommendations and communications to increase client satisfaction and referrals

Questions or Updates?

Contact your operations team for clarifications or to suggest improvements to this guide.

This guide is for internal use by advisors. Keep it handy as a reference throughout the customer journey.